

# A Place on the Team

Name: \_\_\_\_\_ Class: \_\_\_\_\_ Date: \_\_\_\_\_

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**01** At the morning **break**, Amir stood beside the football pitch, turning a small stone under his shoe. He wanted to **join** the game with his classmates.

**02** “Amir, you’re with us,” Noam called. Amir ran onto the pitch. **However**, the boys kept passing the ball **around** him. Twice he raised his hand. Twice the ball went somewhere else.

**03** Noam stopped beside him. “Why are you standing here?”

**04** “No one passes to me,” Amir said. “I can’t get better by watching.”

**05** Noam now had a better **understanding** of the problem. But his team was one goal behind. He **took the game seriously** and wanted to win.

**06** On the next attack, Noam passed to Amir. Amir kicked too quickly and sent the ball to the other team **by mistake**.

**07** “Why did you pass to him?” Dan shouted.

**08** Amir looked down. “It’s **fine**. I’ll **go back** to class.”

**09** “Stay,” Noam said. “Try a short pass. I’ll stand near you. We all make mistakes.”

**10** He gave Amir a quick **explanation** and showed him where to stand. When the ball came again, Amir moved with more **care**. He passed it a short distance to Noam.

**11** They did not score. Later, Amir missed another pass. This time, Dan called, “Try again!”

**12** The bell rang. Their team lost by one goal, but Amir walked back with the others.

**13** “You’ll **be able to** practice with us tomorrow,” Noam said.

**14** The next morning, Amir left the small stone beside the pitch and ran toward his classmates. “Which team am I on?”

**Word help:** pitch = an area for playing a sport • goal = a point in football • short pass = sending the ball to a player near you

# Read, think, write

Answer in English. Use details from the story. Focus words are bold in the text.

1. When and where does the story begin?

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2. Give one detail that shows Amir is on the team but is not really included.

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3. Why is it difficult for Noam to decide to pass to Amir?

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4. What happens when Noam first passes the ball to Amir?

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5. Name two things Noam does to help Amir stay in the game.

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6. How does Dan's reaction to Amir's mistakes change?

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7. What does Amir's question at the end suggest about how he feels? Use a story detail.

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8. Write 3–4 sentences: How can classmates include a player who is still learning? Use one story detail and three focus words.

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